HPV Self-Collection Discussion — OSCE Checklist

Deakin MD2 · ELC8 · Counselling station

Tick each point as you cover it. **Shaded rows (*)** *are covered if relevant.* † *= added from standard teaching, not in the Deakin guideline. Use plain language and check understanding.*

1. Opening

☐	Introduce self, confirm patient ID, explain purpose of the discussion
☐	Ask what the patient knows about cervical screening; screening history (last test, results)
☐	Explore concerns (past experiences, cultural or personal preferences)

2. Check eligibility

	Check	Ask about	If yes
☐	Offer to all	Self-collection is an option for anyone in routine cervical screening	Highly acceptable to under- and never-screened people
☐	Symptoms?	Post-coital, intermenstrual or post-menopausal bleeding; persistent unexplained discharge	Contraindicated → clinician-collected HPV + cytology
☐	Surveillance?	Follow-up after completely excised adenocarcinoma in situ (AIS)	Contraindicated → clinician collection

3. Explain why it's worthwhile

☐	As sensitive as a clinician-collected test; easy to do
☐	Over 70% of Australians diagnosed with cervical cancer were under-screened or never screened
☐	Priority groups*: CALD communities, people with disability, LGBTQIA+ people, rural and remote, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people

4. Teach the technique

☐	Wash hands; find a private, comfortable position †
☐	Twist the cap and remove the swab
☐	Insert swab into the vagina about the length of an index finger
☐	Rotate for at least **10 seconds**
☐	Place swab back in the tube and screw the cap on
☐	Do **not** put the swab down on any surface between opening and closing
☐	Return the sample to the healthcare provider

5. Results and close

☐	Sample goes to a pathology lab for HPV testing; results go to the healthcare provider
☐	Explain follow-up: HPV not detected → rescreen in 5 years; HPV detected → may need a clinician-collected sample or colposcopy †
☐	Teach-back: ask the patient to explain the steps; invite questions; thank patient
☐	Document discussion and plan